

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Administrative Review, reapplying, and what actually changes the outcome

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The ECO wasn't satisfied you met the Appendix V requirements (most commonly, the genuine visitor test or financial evidence).	In most cases, no formal right of appeal - your options are Administrative Review (only where a case-working error is claimed) or a fresh application.
Administrative Review	A review of whether the original decision contains a case-working error, requested within a set window of the refusal (check the current time limit on your decision letter).	Available only in specific circumstances and generally not simply because you disagree with the outcome - read your refusal letter carefully for whether it's offered.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh.	The most common and usually most effective path - but only if something material has actually changed since the refusal.

Read your refusal letter closely

It states the specific reason(s) the ECO wasn't satisfied, and whether Administrative Review is available for your case. Address that reason directly in any reapplication - don't guess.

If you plan to reapply: what actually helps

- Address the specific reason given in the refusal letter, not just the application in general
- Strengthen whichever element was weak - clearer financial evidence, a more specific itinerary, better-documented ties at home
- If financial evidence was the issue, build a longer, more consistent statement history rather than a single larger deposit
- Consider a brief cover letter explaining what's changed since the refusal (see the Cover Letter templates, Complete tier)

What not to do

- Don't reapply immediately with an unchanged application - it's likely to be refused again for the same reason
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application - it's checked, and the omission is worse than the original refusal
- Don't submit materially false information to work around a previous refusal - this can lead to a much longer-term ban on future applications

When to seek professional advice

Most straightforward refusals don't need a lawyer - a clearer reapplication is often enough. Consider consulting an OISC-regulated immigration adviser or solicitor if you've been refused multiple times despite genuinely strengthening your case, or if your case involves a more complex immigration history.